

Σεντεντιῶν Σέκστου

The Sentences of Sextus on Ethics

eul_aid: pxc

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)
Affiliation: [Christian](#)

The *Sententiae Sexti* (Sayings of Sextus) is a collection of ethical advice compiled in Greek during the 2nd century CE. The work is attributed to a figure named Sextus, but this is a pseudonym; the actual compiler or author is unknown. Some ancient readers, like the Christian scholar Origen, thought the sayings came from a Pythagorean philosopher, while others considered them Christian.

The date and place of composition are uncertain, but it likely originated in a Greek-speaking region of the Roman Empire where Christian and traditional philosophical ideas mixed. The work consists of approximately 451 short, moral maxims promoting ideals like self-control, wisdom, purity, and piety.

It survives in several ancient languages, including Greek, Latin, Coptic, and Syriac, showing it was widely circulated. Its inclusion in the Nag Hammadi library, a collection of early Christian texts, further indicates its popularity among diverse communities.

Modern scholars see the *Sententiae Sexti* as a significant example of how early Christian writers adopted and adapted Greek philosophical ethics. The text blends Hellenistic, especially Pythagorean and Stoic, wisdom with a Christian ascetic perspective. Its broad transmission made it an important handbook for moral instruction in late antiquity.

Works (1)

- Γνῶμαι Σέξτου · [Sentences of Sextus](#) · 325 passages

Other Christian Authors

- Αἰνεΐας ὁ Γαζαῖος · [Aeneas of Gaza](#) · 2 works
- Ἀνατόλιος Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · [Anatolius of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- Ἀθηναγόρας ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · [Athenagoras of Athens](#) · 2 works
- Βούθηρος · [Butherus](#) · 1 work
- Κλήμης ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · [Clement of Alexandria](#) · 5 works
- Εὐσέβιος ὁ Καίσαρειας · [Eusebius of Caesarea](#) · 7 works
- Ἱππόλυτος ὁ Ῥωμαῖος · [Hippolytus of Rome](#) · 13 works
- Ἰωάννης ὁ Φιλόπονος · [John Philoponus of Alexandria](#) · 11 works
- Νεμέσιος ὁ Ἐμέσης · [Nemesius of Emesa](#) · 1 work

- [Ὡριγένης ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Origen of Alexandria · 25 works](#)
- [Τατιανὸς ὁ Ἀσσύριος · Tatian the Assyrian · 1 work](#)
- [Θεοδώρητος ὁ Κύρρου · Theodoret of Cyrus · 7 works](#)